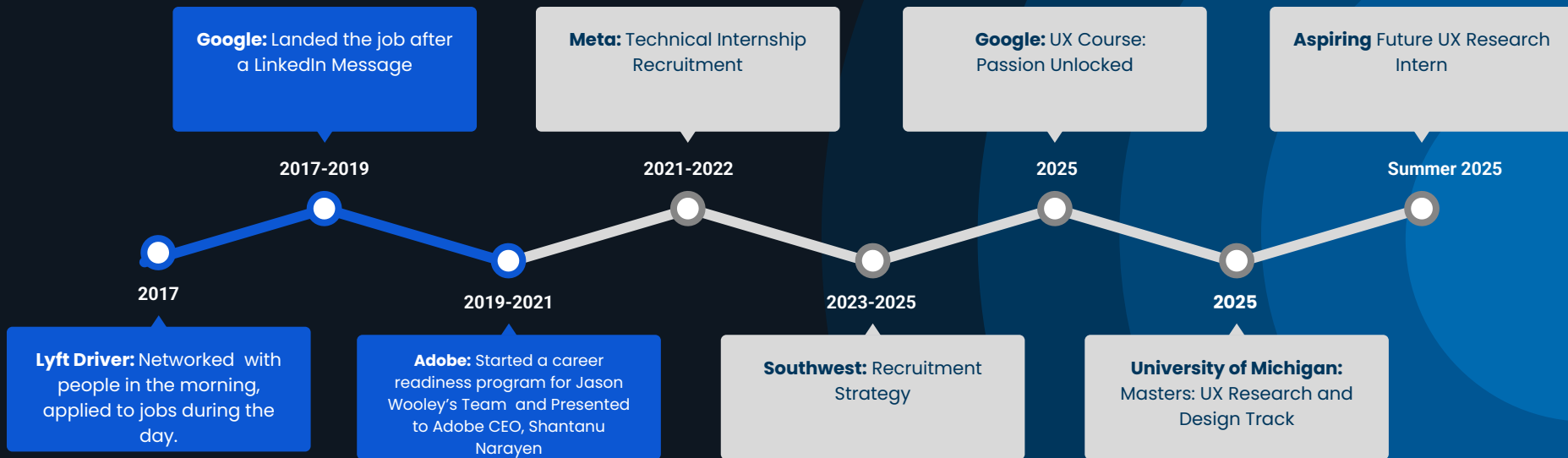




Instructure.

SETTING POTENTIAL IN MOTION

My Work Timeline:

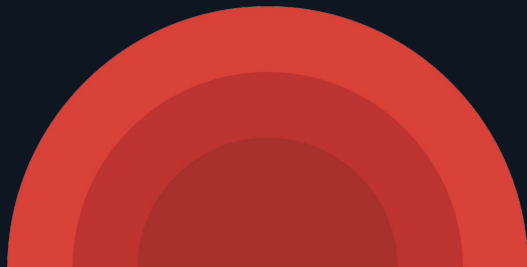


Our mission

To help learners thrive in tomorrow's landscape
by delivering a future-ready ecosystem



The Product Suite:



**Teaching
and learning**



**Assessment
and growth**



**Credentials
and opportunity**

Instructure.

K-12

4,390+ institutions



Springfield Public Schools
A culture of equity and proficiency



- ✓ **51%** of top 250 US K-12 districts use Canvas
- ✓ **11** State-wide deployments during COVID⁴
- ✓ **1,200+** Schools in Queensland, Australia
- ✓ Many of the largest K-12 Systems in the US

Higher Education

2,540+ institutions



- ✓ **50%** of college and university students in the US and Canada
- ✓ All Top Ten Universities in the US
- ✓ All Ivy League Universities
- ✓ **83%** of US research universities
- ✓ **116** California Community Colleges
- ✓ Higher Education systems for Sweden & Norway

Non-traditional



- ✓ **400+** Higher Education institutions cross-sold with Non-traditional solutions

The Problem Statement :

Although Instructure offers a robust ecosystem of learning tools for traditional academic institutions, its current products do not clearly support or speak to individuals pursuing alternative pathways such as bootcamps, micro-credentials, career transitions, or self-paced upskilling. These learners struggle to find relevant entry points, understand how Instructure's tools fit their goals, or navigate content in a way that feels cohesive and aligned with lifelong learning and employability. As a result, Instructure risks missing an emerging and rapidly growing learner segment.



How might we :

How might Instructure refine its **current products** or **develop a new product** to include **individuals on alternative pathways** into its **educational ecosystem**, empowering them by **strengthening lifelong learning** and **employability**, therefore ensuring **Instructure's long-term competitiveness** in the future EdTech Industry.



The Process



Background Research Report

Client Insight → Market Insight → Societal Insight → Competitor Insight → Opportunity Insight

1. Client Insight
 - Conducted informational interview with Instructure's partner
2. Market Insight
 - Performed detailed competitor landscape review
3. Societal Insight
 - Analyzed shifting learning pathways and credential trends
4. Competitor Insight
 - Benchmarked Instructure against top LMS competitors
5. Opportunity Insight
 - Identified critical gaps and opportunities in Instructure's ecosystem

Background Research Report: Alternative Pathways Data

Currently, the proportion of people who do not attend traditional universities, in US

79%

This validates the urgency of **improving non-traditional learning platforms** to serve the dominant learning space.

How many people are in alternative pathway

61%

This highlights a critical opportunity to **strengthen and legitimize alternative education** through better-designed platforms.

What proportion of people are negatively impacted by the lack of a reliable learning platform

29%

Addressing this requires platforms that are **structured, validated, and responsive to learner needs.**

Background Research Report: Competitor Analysis

20 Million Users

D2L/Brightspace

Competitor offers flexible credential ecosystems, including micro-credentials, badges, skill pathways, and employer-integrated dashboards.



Increasing adoption among corporate learning clients

8,901 Users

Cornerstone (On Demand)

Large footprint among corporate and enterprise clients, making it a strong example of LMS usage outside strictly academic settings.



Continues to grow adoption as companies shift toward skills-based workforce upskilling

20 Million Users

Blackboard

Adoption of its modern interface version (Blackboard Learn Ultra) has been growing: institutions using Ultra courses and deployments rose by ~ 30% year-over-year, indicating active investment and updates



Strong adoption of Blackboard Learn Ultra, with growing migration year over year

Live Project Plan

01	Summarized Background Context	• Analyzed social norms that influence learner behaviors • Performing targeted market research
02	Stakeholders Identified	• HR professionals • Alternative Pathway students who did not attend college or attend later in life • Our client partners from different business units
03	Research Method/ Interview Protocol	• Developed an Interview Protocol • Qualitative Research: Interviews • Analyzed the Data through Affinity Diagram
04	Project Details/Roles/Timeline	• Served as the Lead Researcher for the project • Collaborated with the team for 3 hours weekly • Coordinated primarily through Slack and Zoom
05	Project Outputs	• Shared three high-impact recommendations with the client • Showcased a prototype and new visual identity for the system

Research Method: Interviews

Recruitment → Interview Protocol → Interviews Conducted

Recruitment/ Interview Insight

- Recruited HR professionals through professional networks
- Recruited alternative-pathway learners through business community groups
- Included Instructure partner to provide strategic product insight Conducted 10 total interviews across all stakeholder groups

Interview Protocol Insight

Semi-structured script and questions covering:

- Role & background
- Learning journey & barriers
- Hiring experiences & soft-skill needs
- Credential credibility & skill verification
- Opportunities for improved pathways

Stakeholder Group #2

Instructure

- **Overarching question:**
What is Instructure's long-term strategy for evolving its current systems, and what plans does Instructure have to include people who choose alternative pathways into its education ecosystem?
- **Stakeholder description:**
We plan to interview Melissa. She is the Chief Academic Officer at Instructure. We aim to collect qualitative data on Instructure's strategic vision, product ecosystem, and its approach to supporting learners on alternative pathways. The interview is expected to last about 20 minutes.
- **Key questions:**
 1. Could you briefly describe your role at Instructure and how your research connects with the product strategy of Instructure?
 2. What is Instructure's definition of "student in alternative pathways" or "non-traditional student"?
 3. How do you think the needs of an alternative student or nontraditional student differ from those of traditional students?
 4. How well do Instructure's current products support alternative pathway learners, and where do you see the most significant gaps?
 5. From a strategy perspective, what opportunities or risks do you see in expanding

Primary Persona:



Lauren Case

Age: 29

Pathway: Alternative, formal school early, pursued work + self-learning

Hometown: Southfield, MI

Education: Participates in short-term online bootcamps.

Occupation: Operations coordinator at a small company

"I'm done with scattered learning. I want a clear path that actually makes me employability without a formal degree"

Pain Points

- Soft-skill gaps aren't addressed by bootcamps..
- Difficulty translating hustle into employable competencies.
- Barriers in job seeking.

Motivations

- Driven by embarrassment she once felt working with more educated colleagues.
- Wants fair access to jobs without needing a degree.
- Desires a sense of competence and systematic thinking in her work.
- Believes deeply in constant learning and wants guidance, not random self-learning.

Goals

- Build structured knowledge rather than fragmented learning.
- Gain practical soft skills (communication, teamwork, logic, problem-solving).
- Become more "officially qualified" through meaningful micro-credentials.
- Access a pathway that connects learning to real employability.

The image displays three mind maps, each representing a different educational pathway. Each map is structured with a central green box, a top-level pink box, and several branches of blue and yellow boxes.

- Credentialed: context, needs and solution**
 - Context**
 - Education
 - Work
 - Community
 - Family
 - Health
 - Environment
 - Technology
 - Globalization
 - Demographics
 - Politics
 - Economy
 - Society
 - Culture
 - Religion
 - Philosophy
 - Art
 - Literature
 - Science
 - Mathematics
 - History
 - Geography
 - Language
 - Communication
 - Articulation
 - Transfer
 - Equity
 - Inclusion
 - Access
 - Quality
 - Cost
 - Time
 - Flexibility
 - Support
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Three Key Insights

**Designing for
alternative learners is
a major opportunity to
create more flexible,
learner-centered
experiences.**

**The job market rewards soft
skills and connections, but
alternative learners lack the
systems to cultivate them.**

**High motivation, low
structure
alternative learners
need a clearer
learning roadmap.**

Recommendations Analysis: Prioritization Matrix

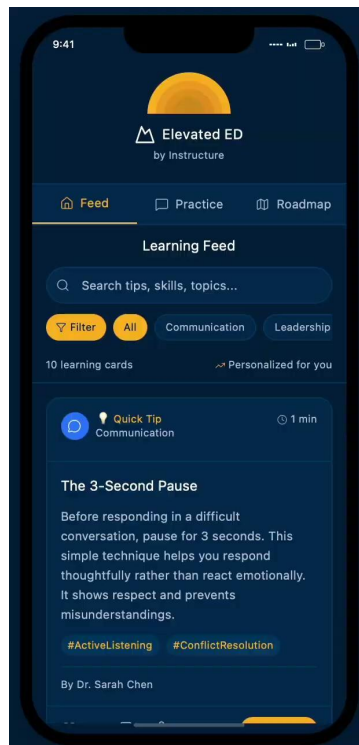
Top 3 Recommendation:

1. Personalized Learning Modular
2. Soft Skills Roadmap
3. AI Soft Skill Development Tool

	Comment: like a solution	Comment: More like a add-on tool	
Selection Criteria	Personalized modular learning platform	Skill tree roadmap for learning progress	Softskill development tools
Alignment with Instructures' Strategy (*2)	4	2	5
Voice of Customer (*1.5)	5	4	3
Voice of the Business (*1.5)	5	2	5
Scalability	5	3	5
Accessbility	5	2	2
Total	33	18	29
Scoring Baseline			
5	Strong alignment		
4	Good alignment		
3	Somewhat aligned		
2	Don't know		
1	No alignment		

Recommendation 1: Personalized modular learning platform

- A feed based platform on search or personalized recommendations
- Designed for users who don't have a long block of time for learning
- Supports unplanned or curiosity-based learning behaviors, giving users a low-pressure, flexible starting point to learn something new.

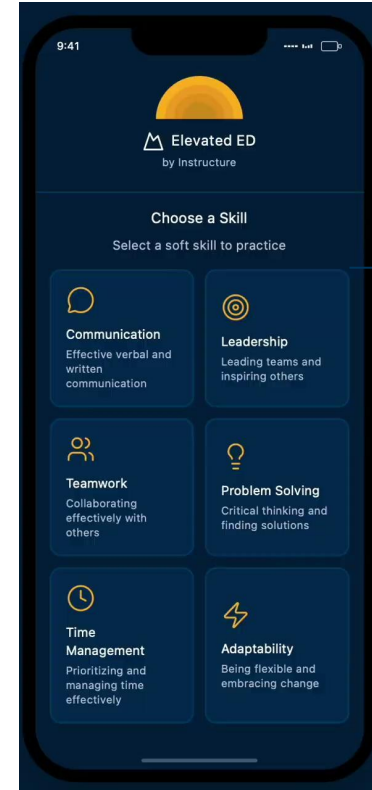


Pain Points:
Lack of time

Recommendation 2:

AI Soft Skills Tool

- **Encourages users to reflect on both technical and interpersonal skills.**
- **Provides opportunities to practice articulating learning experiences with clarity and confidence.**
- **Enhances users' employability by showcasing growth and transferable competencies.**



Pain Point: Lack of Soft Skills

Feedback from Client Consultant

Personalized modular learning platform

Constraints: Requires content partnerships or a modular content taxonomy.



Soft-skill development tool

Constraints: Soft skills are hard to “measure” or validate. You might need to micro-simulations, or course-integrated practice.

Client Overall Impressions

“Your team delivered one of the strongest, most future-focused strategies we’ve seen.”

“All solutions support a larger narrative of helping learners make sense of their skills, progress, and employability over time.”

Next steps:

Presented our strategy to Instructure's full strategy team, and over 180 University of Michigan students today

Q & A

Secondary Persona:

"We look for teamwork, adaptability, communication — the soft skills that set people apart."



Andrea Smith

Age: 34

Pathway: Traditional, Formal Schooling

Hometown: Charleston, SC

Education: Masters in HR from Penn

Occupation: Corporate HR Specialist, 8+ years in hiring, screening, and evaluating talent

Pain Points

- Verification difficulty
- Resume filters
- Inconsistency
- Lack of translation
- Candidate articulation:

Motivations

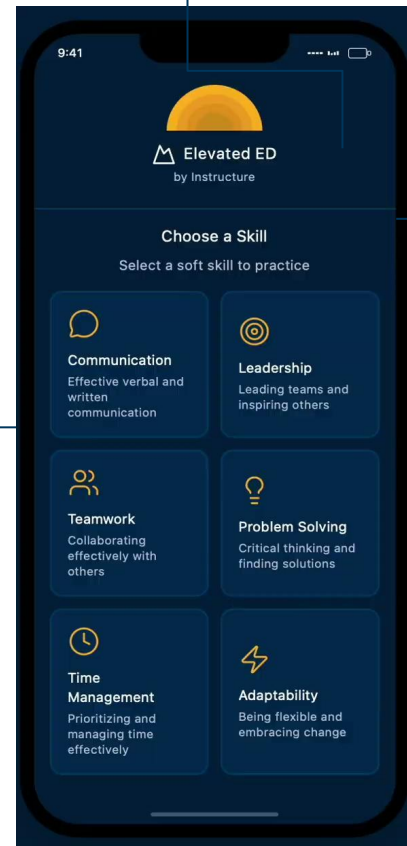
- Wants candidates who demonstrate *ownership, reliability, professionalism, and teamwork*.
- Believes that interpersonal and soft skills often matter more than a degree.
- Appreciates clear, specific examples of applied skills (metrics, achievements, leadership moments).
- Values certifications only if they're issued by trusted, recognizable organizations.

Goals

- Hire candidates who can perform consistently, work well in fast-paced environments, and uphold service standards.
- Reduce risk by ensuring candidates' skills are valid, verifiable, and aligned with actual job requirements.
- Streamline hiring by filtering large applicant pools efficiently.
- Improve clarity in resumes so she can quickly gauge qualifications.
- Build a fairer process that does not unintentionally filter out strong nontraditional candidates.

Recommendations:

Personalized
Learning
Modular



AI Soft Skills
Tool